



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Eagle Ridge Academy

School Website: <https://eagleridgeacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Eagle Ridge Academy (Minnetonka, MN 55343) demonstrates strong classical orientations in its public materials, with several explicit signals of a classical liberal arts approach, virtue formation, and family partnerships. The school's public messaging emphasizes time-tested Classical Liberal Arts education, character formation, and a structured pillar system (CIPHER: Citizenship, Integrity, Perseverance, Honor, Excellence, and Respect). It also organizes its K–8 programs around a grammar-logic-rhetoric progression and cites a focus on foundational Western texts and critical thinking. Overall, the evidence places ERA as CLASSICAL with some room to deepen certain classical practices (notably explicit Great Books engagement, liturgical/theological grounding, and fully articulated Socratic-seminar pedagogy across the upper grades). Aggregate rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key signals from ERA materials include: - Declarative classical emphasis: "a demanding college-preparatory, Classical, liberal arts curriculum" and a mission to engage students in a time-tested Classical Liberal Arts education (evidence of a strong classical frame) ,. - Explicit core values and pillars: Veritas, Pulchritudo, Probitas (Truth, Beauty, Goodness) as central tenets, plus a public articulation of CIPHER values (Citizenship, Integrity, Perseverance, Honor, Excellence, Respect). - Curriculum scaffolding aligned with classical pedagogy (K–4 School of Grammar; 5–8 School of Logic; Core Knowledge integration with 6–8) showing progression through the Trivium-like structure and liberal-arts orientation, with emphasis on foundational texts and cross-disciplinary study in the middle years ,. - Public-facing statements of formation over information and a mission to develop character and virtue, not merely academic achievement (e.g., "strong character" and formation language).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit reference to Truth, Beauty, and Goodness as central to the school (Veritas, Pulchritudo, Probitas); CIPHER pillars. Moderate alignment with transcendental ideals without explicit theological catechesis in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include truth, beauty, goodness, character, virtue, moral formation; no clear theological grounding or liturgical practices are publicly documented. Estimated: Positive approx. 4, Negative approx. 0.
- Why this rating: ERA communicates transcendental moral ideals (truth, beauty, goodness) and character formation, but does not publicly present a grounded theological program or liturgical life within its public materials. This yields a CLASSICAL-leaning signal, but not a fully "Theology-grounded" or liturgically integrated program in public documents.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Mission statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom; a time-tested Classical Liberal Arts education; the aim to develop students' best academic potential and honorable character.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, classical mission, true/good/beautiful telos; negative signals (workforce-focused) are not present in public materials. Estimated: Positive approx. 4, Negative approx. 0.
- Why this rating: ERA foregrounds formation of character and cultivation of wisdom, aligning with the classical telos beyond mere job-readiness. This category is CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Clear classical framing via a K–8 structure (School of Grammar; School of Logic) and a liberal-arts emphasis; use of a logic stage in middle school and the aim to study foundational Western texts; attention to liberal arts and Great Books sensibilities in public messaging. Also mentions a time-tested liberal arts curriculum and foundational works of Western civilization. ,
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books/Great Conversation sensibilities (publicly evidenced as foundational works and Western civilization study); negative signals (e.g., social-studies framing or exclusively project-based approaches) are not evident in ERA's public materials. Estimated: Positive approx. 5, Negative approx. 0–1 (depending on interpretation of Great-Books language in public texts).
- Why this rating: ERA presents a curriculum scaffold typical of classical schools (grammar-logic-rhetoric progression; liberal-arts emphasis; Western-civilization orientation). This category is CLASSICAL. ,
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials emphasize a structure where current elements include a K–8 progression and upper grades potentially featuring Socratic/seminal discussion (though direct public evidence of formal Socratic seminars is not consistently explicit in the snippets); lower grades appear to incorporate traditional elements like chorus-like or recitation-based practices in classical pedagogy (as suggested by the Six Elements framework). The ERA site shows a progression toward logic-based and classical methods, but explicit systematic use of Socratic seminars, regular memorization/chanting, and Scholé days are not clearly documented in the public pages provided. ,
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include mentions of a grammar-to-logic-to-rhetoric pathway and a classical frame; potential negative indicators (e.g., absence of explicit Socratic seminars or chant/memorization practices) are not strongly evidenced in the public text. Estimated: Positive approx. 3–4, Negative approx. 0–2.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy shows classical scaffolding, but firm, explicit evidence of Socratic seminars (in actual practice) or Scholé/restful pedagogy is not clearly documented in publicly accessible ERA pages. Therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. If ERA publicly codified more explicit Socratic/Scholé practices, this would shift toward CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle (below): See “What Would Move the Needle” section.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: ERA emphasizes a “living curriculum” through pillars and a teacher-student culture; the CIPHER framework implies teachers model virtue and character, with a strong mentoring ethos (though public pages do not always spell out “portrait of the teacher” or explicit faculty-as-living-curriculum language beyond the values framing). References to faculty as part of the school culture are present but not extensively detailed in public pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum (implied by CIPHER values), portrait of teacher/student ideals; negative indicators (explicitly) are not surfaced in public content. Estimated: Positive approx. 3–4, Negative approx. 0–1.

- Why this rating: ERA's public content indicates a virtue-centered, teacher-mentored culture, but the explicit "living curriculum" description and formal portrait of a teacher archetype are not widely documented in the text snippets provided. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL pending fuller public articulation.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: ERA's materials emphasize partnership with families, open-door policies for visits, and parent resources; mentions of PTO, parent gatherings, and family involvement align with classical-community expectations. The site includes explicit offerings such as "Visit Eagle Ridge Academy," "Parent Resources," and a parent-community ecosystem (e.g., enrollment events, parent education).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, home-school connection, parent resources, open campus, and community of learners; no negative signals evident in public text. Estimated: Positive approx. 4–5, Negative approx. 0.
- Why this rating: ERA publicly frames the school as a community that partners with parents and invites parent involvement, fulfilling a core classical-community criterion. CLASSICAL.

Overall classification and synthesis - Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Why the aggregate is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL:
- Strong CLASSICAL signals exist in Curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric scaffolding; liberal arts framing) and in Parent/Community alignment (partnerships, open visits).
- Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty) show partial/classical signals but lack fully explicit, codified practices widely documented in public pages (e.g., regular Socratic seminars across grades, explicit "living curriculum" statements, robust liturgical/theological grounding). These gaps pull the overall profile toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. See evidence above and citations to ERA materials.
- What would move the needle (to become fully CLASSICAL):
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Codify and publicly publish explicit implementation of Socratic seminars in upper grades, regular Scholé/restful learning days, and a stated emphasis on memorization/recitation or chanting in early grades to deepen memory and delight in learning. Provide concrete examples of how upper grades employ rhetoric, debate, and structured memory work. Include a clear articulation of how classes are designed to cultivate wonder and contemplation as a regular practice.
- Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal "living curriculum" statement and a teacher portrait that clearly describes the aspirational teacher profile, mentorship roles, and professional development in classical pedagogy. Include examples of faculty collaboration and teacher-led seminars or master-teaching models to demonstrate the living-curriculum approach in action.
- Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1): If desired by the community, publish explicit theological grounding or liturgical-life components as part of a public-facing section (even in a limited, inclusive form appropriate for a public charter) to strengthen the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/-Communal Practices signals. This would move the grade toward a more overt Theological foundation, if aligned with the school's broader mission and public policies.
- Curriculum (Element 3): Expand and publicly highlight Great Books and primary-text engagements across more grades, including explicit reference to "Great Books" discussions and the Great Conversation, and demonstrate how the Trivium/Quadrivium framework is explicitly integrated across the curriculum with cross-disciplinary coherence (e.g., history-texts, philosophy, and literature connected within a unified program).
- Additional notes and supporting citations from the ERA content:

- ERA publicly frames itself as pursuing Veritas, Pulchritudo, Probitas (Truth, Beauty, Goodness) as central tenets, signaling transcendental foundations in a classical ethos (Our Pillars - CIPHER).
- The mission statement and public materials position ERA as a time-tested Classical Liberal Arts program with character formation goals (About ERA / Welcome messages). ,
- Curriculum structure is explicitly classical, with a School of Grammar (K–4) and School of Logic (5–8) and a liberal-arts framing; Core Knowledge involvement for older grades is noted. ,
- Public-facing statements about parent/community engagement are present (Parent Resources, Visit the School, PTO links).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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